

Dear project writer,

Conducting your final thesis project and writing your thesis successfully are comprehensive tasks that will occupy a substantial amount (if not all) of your study time in your final semester. In the following we will provide some general advice as well as an outline on how we would like to organize the supervision.

You will meet once a week at a supervision meeting with me and any co-supervisor. Prior to the meeting you will have sent us a **weekly report** outlining the past week's work and plans for the coming week(s). The weekly reports serve a series of purposes

- they focus our discussion in the limited time we have at the supervision meeting and allow your fellow student to understand and contribute to your project,
- they document your progress and work and should be written in a thesis-ready language and use plenty of images, graphs, tables, drawings, and references
- They allow you to collect and curate material such as figures and tables incl. figure/table captions, reference lists (get your bibtex/refman/endnote running from day one), methodology/theory sections, text etc. that can be used immediately in your final report.

The first weekly report should contain

- A project plan
- Your understanding of the project (background, data, system setup, goals, potential methods, prior work)

At our first meeting we will discuss the project and the **project plan**. Formally, you have to submit such a plan within the first month. However, it is also a very useful tool in managing your project. The project plan can be in the form of a time schedule roughly outlining activities specific to your project (literature/stat-of-the-art review, data collecting, visualization of data, methodological development/programming/experiments, implementation and testing, writing thesis). Each element should have a risk assessment (1-5 scale, low to high risk) assigned to it (a typical risk is delay).

At the **weekly meeting** the quality of feedback from your supervisors and fellow students will be proportional to the quality of your report and your preparation. You will likely receive plenty of ideas and suggestions that you should write down and prioritize (with your supervisor). You should limit the use of us for tool-like questions such as latex formatting, python coding, etc.

A template for weekly reports and project plan prepared by my colleague professor Rasmus Paulsen can be found here:

<https://www2.compute.dtu.dk/~rapa/Templates/MasterThesis.zip>

The **final report** should demonstrate your command of the state-of-the-art and your contribution in a clear and concise manner. Our former head of department study board

professor Andreas Bærentzen has provided some excellent advice here: <https://www.imm.dtu.dk/~janba/MastersThesisAdvice.pdf>. All though it is a few years old it continues to be good advice. The report should not be excessively long but should focus on a clear introduction to the goals of the project, the choice of solutions with references to the state-of-the-art, the methodology applied, the implementation, experimentation, data analysis, and tests, and a summary and conclusion with respect to the goals you set out to achieve. A LaTeX template for the thesis can be found here: <https://da.overleaf.com/latex/templates/dtu-thesis-template/dyxwwkhmzrbx>

You will apply scientific methodology and it is expected that your work can also be published scientifically. We therefore want as part of the thesis to receive a draft manuscript (in an appendix) prepared for submission to a scientific journal or conference. We will discuss this during the course of the work.

Best regards

Rasmus